

Rating Area 8: Philadelphia Metro

Hub: Philadelphia | Counties: Bucks, Chester, Delaware, Montgomery, Philadelphia

21.5% PID-approved avg. individual rate hike	102% avg. net premium increase, 2026	443,024 PA enrollees as of June 1, 2026	160,000+ cumulative PA terminations
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THE STATEWIDE PICTURE

The federal enhanced premium tax credits expired December 31, 2025, and Congress has not restored them; combined with the Pennsylvania Insurance Department's (PID) approved 21.5% average individual-market rate increase, Pennie reports the average net premium for the affected population rose 102% for 2026 (Pennsylvania Insurance Department, 2025; Pennie, 2026a). Statewide, 85,000 people dropped Pennie coverage during Open Enrollment; as of June 1, 2026, cumulative cancellations exceed 160,000 and total enrollment stands at 443,024 (Pennie, 2026a, 2026b). Pennsylvania's own relief program, the Act 54 state subsidy, remains unfunded as the state budget missed its June 30, 2026 deadline for the fifth year running (Spotlight PA, 2026).

CARRIERS & RATES IN THIS AREA

The most carrier-dense market in the Commonwealth — Keystone Health Plan East (Independence/IBX), QCC, Oscar, Ambetter, Partners Insurance, and Health Partners Plans all compete here (Pennsylvania Insurance Department, 2025b). Independence Blue Cross is phasing out broad PPO options in favor of tiered "Proactive" HMO networks, making it essential to confirm your specific specialists sit in the plan's top cost-sharing tier, not just its network generally.

HIGH TRANSACTION VOLUME MEANS MORE BILLING DISPUTES

With more carriers, more hospital systems, and more claims volume than any other rating area, Philadelphia-area enrollees are statistically more likely to encounter an out-of-network pathology, radiology, or anesthesiology charge appended to an in-network facility visit. Under the No Surprises Act, these ancillary-service charges are protected — check your Explanation of Benefits for exactly this pattern before paying.

YOUR CONSUMER PROTECTIONS

If a directory error sends you out-of-network: 28 Pa. Code § 9.725 caps your liability at in-network cost-sharing, and Act 252 of 2023 presumes an undisclosed out-of-network balance bill illegal. The federal IDR process (45 C.F.R. § 149.510) is a *provider-vs-plan* tool only — you cannot file one yourself; use the protections above instead.

Enroll / compare plans: pennie.com or 1-844-844-8040	File a complaint: pa.gov/consumer or 1-866-722-6675
Free legal help: phlp.org or 1-800-274-3258	Medicare counseling: PA MEDI 1-800-783-7067

- SOURCES (APA)**
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